

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 371

Culture (OWC): [Akan \(FE12\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Western Africa

Field Date: 1921-192?

Coverage Date: Not Specified

Place Coverage: Ashanti; Ghana

Section Title(S)

Other modes of enforcing payment of a debt: • The Custom known as Bo Mmokwa:

In another sense, however, there is not any 'statute of limitations' with regard to recovery of a debt. *Eka mporo*¹ ('a debt never rots') is a well-known legal maxim in Ashanti.

[426
Borrowing And Lending](#)
[782
Prayers And Sacrifices](#)

The Custom known as Bo Mmokwa:

In addition to the loans just examined, there is in Ashanti an expression *bo mmokwa*, which refers to a loan for some special occasion or day between friends, of a cloth or gun or some other article. There was generally neither security nor valuable consideration, but in the case of a gun the lender would seem to have expected a *basa* (foreleg) of any game that fell to it, for there is a joking allusion to the custom which runs, *Wo de wo tuo bo mmokwa gye abasa a, ete* ('When you lend your gun in hope of getting a foreleg, it will burst').² There is also a term *fame*, which means a monetary accommodation between two great friends without interest, security, or any specified time being named for repayment.

[426
Borrowing And Lending](#)

¹ Also heard sometimes in the form of *Eka kye emporo*.

² The borrower is not responsible.

*755 Prospect Street
New Haven, CT 06511*

General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu



[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)